PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience delivering enterprise-scale security operations across large hybrid environments. I have deep hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel security information and event management (SIEM), Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection engineering, and the full Microsoft Defender suite including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender. I bring strong experience in identity and access management through Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory, single sign-on (SSO), multi-factor authentication (MFA), Conditional Access, and public key infrastructure (PKI) certificate lifecycle management. I hold the CISSP certification and complement my Microsoft tooling depth with expertise in CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, vulnerability management, and security orchestration, automation and response (SOAR). I am seeking a permanent senior hybrid role where I can drive security engineering delivery across a Microsoft-centric enterprise environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel with KQL - advanced detection rule authoring, analytics, workbook dashboards, SOAR playbook automation; CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; Splunk/SPL
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender - deployed and managed across 8,000 users
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory); Conditional Access; multi-factor authentication (MFA); single sign-on (SSO); privileged identity management
- **Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) and Certificate Management:** Digital certificate lifecycle management; certificate authority (CA) administration; renewal, monitoring and revocation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM) - Expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Logic Apps); CrowdStrike Falcon Fusion; PowerShell automation scripting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Nessus; AppCheck; Pentera breach and attack simulation (BAS)
- **Mobile Device and Application Management:** Microsoft Intune - mobile device management (MDM) and mobile application management (MAM)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM platform
- **Email and Endpoint Security:** Mimecast email security; Check Point Harmony; Tanium
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 framework; MITRE ATT&CK framework; threat hunting and digital forensics
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Deploy, configure and operate Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, authoring KQL detection rules, analytics queries and workbook dashboards to improve threat visibility and reduce false positive alert volume.
- Administer the full Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI and Microsoft 365 Defender) across an 8,000-user enterprise estate, maintaining platform health, tuning alert policies and leading incident investigation.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) and design Conditional Access policies, enforcing MFA and SSO to implement zero-trust identity controls across on-premises and cloud resources.
- Manage the organisation's PKI and digital certificate lifecycle, monitoring expiry dates, co-ordinating certificate renewals, and maintaining certificate authority (CA) configuration to ensure continuous service availability.
- Design and deploy SOAR automation playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and PowerShell, automating alert enrichment, ticket creation and containment actions to decrease mean time to respond (MTTR).

- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM) alongside Sentinel, integrating endpoint telemetry to enrich detection coverage and correlation across the hybrid environment.
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck and Pentera BAS; prioritise remediation by exploitability and business impact; track findings to closure with IT operations teams.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM to enforce least-privilege access, manage privileged sessions and support audit and compliance requirements.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM to enforce device compliance and Conditional Access, ensuring only compliant managed devices access corporate resources.
- Lead incident response activities aligned with NIST SP 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK framework; produce post-incident reports and drive security control improvements.
- Conduct threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight to proactively identify indicators of compromise (IOC) and indicators of attack (IOA).

University of the Arts London (UAL)
Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Built and tuned Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and KQL detection queries, reducing false positives and improving signal fidelity across identity, endpoint and cloud log sources.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) across the enterprise, configuring detection policies and maintaining platform health.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (AAD), implementing Conditional Access policies and enforcing MFA for all users to reduce credential-based attack surface.
- Managed digital certificates and PKI components, monitoring certificate expiry, renewing certificates across web services and internal systems, and maintaining certificate revocation lists.
- Managed SSO configuration across enterprise SaaS applications, simplifying user access and enforcing consistent authentication policies.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM deployment and ongoing administration, onboarding privileged accounts and configuring password vaulting and session recording.
- Conducted daily SIEM alert triage and investigation, co-ordinating incident containment and resolution with IT infrastructure and application teams.
- Managed vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and AppCheck, generating stakeholder reports and driving remediation through change management processes.
- Configured Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM policies across Windows, macOS, iOS and Android devices, enforcing corporate security baselines.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)
IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Configured and administered Microsoft 365 Defender and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) in a SaaS and FinTech environment, managing security policies and responding to alerts.
- Managed PKI and digital certificate lifecycle for internal and customer-facing services, monitoring certificate validity and co-ordinating renewals to prevent service outages.
- Implemented SSO and MFA across corporate and SaaS applications, improving identity security posture and reducing credential exposure risk.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM deployment to enforce device compliance policies and ensure only authorised, patched devices could access corporate resources.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities, contributing to risk assessments, gap analyses and audit evidence preparation.
- Administered firewall rules and network access controls, managing inbound and outbound traffic policies to protect infrastructure boundaries.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel SIEM detection coverage with 50+ KQL analytics rules, reducing false positives and significantly improving alert-to-incident conversion rates.
- Deployed the full Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across an 8,000-user estate, achieving complete endpoint and identity threat visibility.

- Designed and implemented Conditional Access and MFA policies in Microsoft Entra ID for 8,000 users, materially reducing identity-based attacks and unauthorised access attempts.
- Implemented SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing manual alert handling effort and decreasing mean time to respond (MTTR) to critical incidents.
- Established a mature PKI certificate lifecycle management process, eliminating certificate-related service outages and ensuring continuous compliance with internal and external audit requirements.
- Deployed Pentera breach and attack simulation (BAS) to validate security controls continuously and prioritise vulnerability remediation by real-world exploitability.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)